Westbrook City Council

~ Special Meeting ~

Date: Monday, September 21, 2026
Time: 6:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1228982323
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_09212026-1031

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *This Special meeting, called by Mayor Morse to keep the legislative calendar moving, functioned like a typical Regular meeting. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

Mayor's Message

Finance Director Appointment, Eviction Prevention Funding, CBA Context & Amazon Gorham [4:41]

Discussion Summary

Mayor Morse announced the selection of Bruno Nacio (name as heard on the audio — no packet documentation confirms the spelling) as Westbrook's next Finance Director. Nacio brings 20+ years of public- and private-sector leadership experience, most recently as Director of Finance and Administrative Services for the Maine Secretary of State (overseeing a budget over $70 million), previously Deputy of Public Services for the Maine Bureau of Motor Vehicles, and roughly eight years in leadership roles at Unum. He begins work with the City September 28; his appointment comes before Council for confirmation at the October 5, 2026 meeting, where he will attend in person. The Mayor thanked outgoing Interim Finance Director Laura King for her work through budget season, and thanked Councilor Chau for serving on the interview panel.

The Maine Eviction Prevention Program (administered by MaineHousing with Project Home) reopened to new applications that day, offering up to $9,600 in rental assistance to eligible households behind on rent, prioritized for households already facing an eviction court case. Residents can contact Project Home (207-274-1240) or Westbrook's own General Assistance & Social Services office (Harrison Dia, Community Center/Fred C. Westcott Building, 426 Bridge St., 207-854-0676).

Ahead of the evening's vote on the General Unit Collective Bargaining Agreement, the Mayor spoke about how labor agreements fit into the budget, noting the agreement's FY27 cost is covered within funds already appropriated.

The Mayor acknowledged resident concern about a proposed Amazon facility in Gorham and potential truck traffic through Westbrook, noting the City has no vote over the Gorham project itself but is participating in MaineDOT's traffic movement permit process and will press for mitigation measures funded by Amazon rather than Westbrook taxpayers.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

City Council Messages

Disc Golf Tournament Thanks & Remote-Audibility Reminder [13:18]

Discussion Summary

President Munro thanked everyone who came out for the Westbrook Education Foundation's inaugural disc golf tournament (60+ golfers, 15–20 families). Councilor Rairdon asked councilors and presenters to keep the microphone up so residents following remotely can hear clearly.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

Orders of the Day — Second & Final Reading

Orders 2026-96 through -101 — Federal Forfeiture Funds, Police Vehicle, Byrne JAG Grant, Cameras, Pump Station Roof & Plate Compactor (Consent) [14:51]

Discussion Summary

All six first-read September 14, 2026 (see that meeting's summary for details) and read together by title only this evening: acceptance of $6,357.10 in federal asset forfeiture funds; confirmation of the emergency-authorized police vehicle purchase; the $14,447 Byrne JAG grant for training equipment; the five-year Motorola body-worn/cruiser camera agreement; the $32,643 Pershing Way pump station roof replacement; and the $7,500 plate compactor purchase. No discussion.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed together by unanimous roll call, 5–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-102: 2026–2029 Collective Bargaining Agreement, Westbrook General Unit

[16:29] City Clerk Ellis Ledoux read into the record a written comment from resident Mark Fournier, asking the City to publish a detailed multi-year fiscal-impact estimate for the contract before the final vote — including payroll, COLA and step increases, overtime, leave cash-out liability, health insurance, and retirement contributions.

> *“The packet describes the deal in vague terms... It does not include a multi-year cost estimate of what these costs will look like to taxpayers... I am asking if you could provide the three-year cost estimate before Monday's meeting.”*

— Mark Fournier (written comment, read into the record) [17:24]

City Administrator Angela Holmes responded that under 1 M.R.S. §402(3)(D), materials prepared specifically for collective-bargaining negotiations are exempt from public-records disclosure, and that the City has not historically prepared separate fiscal-impact analyses for negotiated agreements. She did share one figure: the FY27 cost of the General Unit's COLA increases and longevity bonuses is $45,573.56, within the Mayor's office contingency line already appropriated in the adopted budget; costs for the contract's second and third years will be incorporated into the FY28 and FY29 budget cycles, with the Finance Committee reviewing wage-driven cost impacts annually.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 5–0.

Order 2026-103: Spring Street/Thomas Drive Street Closures

Procopio Companies Utility Work — Overnight and 24-Hour Closures Authorized

[23:42]

Found on page 168 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Authorizes two closures requested by Procopio Companies for sewer-infrastructure work tied to their residential project at 984 Spring Street: an overnight closure (7 PM–7 AM) of southern Spring Street, October 5–16, 2026; and a single 24-hour closure of Thomas Drive at 34 Thomas Drive sometime between November 16–27, 2026. Representatives from Procopio, Sargent, and Reveler attended to answer questions.

Councilor Rairdon asked how the overnight Spring Street closure would affect a nearby daycare's early drop-off hours; staff and the contractor confirmed a signed detour loop through South Portland would be in place and committed to contacting the daycare directly. President Munro noted the closure period is actually ten days, not the couple of days initially described. Councilor Chau asked about expected noise levels; the contractor explained the work involves one night of saw-cutting followed by excavation, a large excavator, backup alarms, a compaction roller, and light plants, and agreed to keep ambient job-site noise reasonable.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 5–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-104: Final Adoption of the BCC Ordinance Amendments

Seven Boards, Commissions & Committees Updated; ZBA/VROZ Land-Use Portions Deferred [32:53]

Found on page 218 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Finally adopts the ordinance amendments for seven boards, commissions, and committees reviewed by the Committee of the Whole on July 20 and September 14, 2026: the Board of Assessment Review, Board of Trustees of the Woodlawn Cemetery, Fair Hearing Authority, Library Advisory Committee, Planning Board, Zoning Board of Appeals, and Village Review Overlay Zone Committee. City Administrator Holmes recapped the standardized clerical changes applied across all of them: term lengths capped at three years, ward-specific seat requirements removed, gendered language eliminated, and term-end dates standardized to June 30.

Amendments for the first five bodies take effect immediately. The Zoning Board of Appeals and Village Review Overlay Zone Committee amendments adopted tonight cover only provisions outside the Land Use Ordinance; the Land-Use-related portions of those two bodies' amendments (including the VROZ Committee's planned elimination) require a Planning Board public hearing first and will return to Council later. Two remaining bodies — the Recreation & Conservation Commission and the Public Safety Commission — are still under separate review and are expected before the Committee of the Whole in October.

Councilor Chau asked whether affected board and committee members had been made aware of and given a chance to weigh in on these changes. Holmes confirmed all current members received notice of the relevant Committee of the Whole meeting dates; feedback was received from some but not all; and where boards raised unresolved concerns, those items were tabled for separate handling rather than included in tonight's vote.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (Vice President Shaughnessy's first recorded vote of the evening).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-105: Removing Required Address Disclosure During Public Comment (4–2)

[40:15] Amends Section 4(G) of the Council's Rules of Order so that public comment speakers are asked to state their name and whether they are a Westbrook resident or business owner/representative, rather than their home address — a change previewed September 14 based on legal counsel's advice that compelled address disclosure may raise safety concerns and discourage participation.

Point/Counterpoint — does losing address disclosure cost ward representation? Councilor Chau opposed the change, arguing that as a ward-elected councilor he relies on knowing a speaker's ward to decide how closely to follow up with them afterward, and that his objection isn't about privacy but about knowing whom specifically to represent.

> *"I don't really care where you live, I just care which ward you're in, quite frankly... Am I supposed to represent you or not? Specifically represent you."*

— Councilor Victor Chau [41:54]

Councilor McCambridge echoed Chau's concern, and Vice President Shaughnessy asked whether requiring only ward disclosure (short of a full address) might be a legally viable middle ground. Councilor Rairdon pushed back, arguing all seven councilors represent the entire city and that requiring personal identifying information from speakers no longer fits current safety norms.

> *“Quite frankly, I think all seven of us represent the entire city of Westbrook... This day and age when you have your address out there... it's crazy... I would hope that every one of us up here are for every single ward.”*

— Councilor Gary Rairdon [45:59]

President Munro and City Administrator Holmes clarified the amendment doesn't prohibit a speaker from voluntarily sharing their ward or address, and that going forward the Clerk's office could invite (without requiring) ward disclosure as part of the standard public-comment prompt.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed 4–2 (McCambridge and Chau opposed; Shaughnessy, Faulkingham, Rairdon, and Munro in favor).

Order 2026-106: Portable Traffic Signals (First Reading)

$64,891.31 Ver-Mac Signals to Reduce Reliance on Human Flaggers [48:10]

Found on page 257 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Authorizes the purchase of one set of Ver-Mac portable traffic signals from Federal Contracts Company of Tampa, FL for $64,891.31, sourced through GSA cooperative purchasing as the lowest-cost bidder. Public Services Operations Manager Doug Eaton explained the signals let Public Services control traffic flow in work zones without dedicated human flaggers — a position that has been difficult to hire for — freeing staff for other assignments; the City deliberately chose a simpler model without camera/internet connectivity to reduce points of failure.

Councilor McCambridge asked about expected lifespan and warranty terms; Eaton estimated comparable equipment lasts up to 20 years depending on use and storage, and agreed to bring specific figures back for the second reading. Councilor Chau asked for a cost comparison against hiring a human flagger for a full day; staff agreed to provide that analysis (noting Director Eric Dudley's estimate that 2–4 flagger positions are typically needed depending on shift coverage). Councilor Rairdon ran a rough comparison (roughly $320/year amortized over a 20-year lifespan against $20–22/hour flagger wages) and called it a good investment. President Munro asked whether the signals must run continuously; Eaton confirmed they can run unattended overnight when a closure can't be completed same-day.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed on first reading by unanimous voice vote; second and final reading scheduled for October 5, 2026.

Action Items

None.

Closing & Executive Session

No Public Comment, No Referrals — Council Enters Executive Session [57:41]

Discussion Summary

No public comment (in person or online) on the final call, no referrals, and no committee reports. The Council voted to enter a brief executive session under 1 M.R.S. §405(6)(A) (discussion of an appointment) and §405(6)(E) (consultation with the City's attorney). The meeting adjourned following that session.

Key Decisions

✓ Motion to enter executive session approved.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names and figures against the official packet and the city council roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the presiding officer) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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